

the grocery store aisles with their coupon binders and boxes, the ones who intimately knew the “high” that could be had from a good deal. As I delved deeper, I posted calls for submissions on websites like RefundCents.com and HotCouponWorld.com, and I discovered that not only did my fellow couponers enjoy saving money, but they loved talking about it as well. This was not unexpected. In several research studies, the conclusion was that the “super savers” differed from the average shopper with their extreme enthusiasm in talking about their deals, a phenomenon my friends and family can attest to regarding my own super shopping trips.

Long before the ease of networking via the Internet, I was avidly pursuing like-minded women for support as a stay-at-home mom. In one town, it was morning coffee at a friend’s house while our children played together. In another, where my husband took master’s courses at the university, my new friend Mary introduced me to a weekly playgroup at her church. And there were always magazines like the now-defunct *Women’s Circle* where I could choose pen-pals with similar interests.

So it was in connecting with other couponers. In the 1980s and early 1990s, refunding and couponing magazines proliferated. At one time I subscribed to several: *Refundle Bundle*, *Moneytalk*, *Refund Express*, and *Refunding Makes Cents*. Each would arrive in my mailbox on a different day of the month, and I could usually pay for my subscriptions by writing articles or by being the first to send in a new form for credit. As a stay-at-home mom of several young children, I struggled to make ends meet. Couponing and refunding allowed me to stretch my budget, but like most stay-at-home moms, I often felt isolated. Trading with other couponers